

Macular Degeneration... Macular Regeneration

Natural Medicine for Self-Healing: Starter Excerpt

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What follows is drawn from the case histories that open *Macular Degeneration... Macular Regeneration*, the preface, the introduction, and the opening pages of the first chapter. It is offered here exactly as he wrote it, lightly arranged, so you can hear directly from him before deciding whether to go further.

Foreward

What makes true healing work such a joy, and a labor of love, is the results we see in our patients, clients, patrons, readers, friends and family... anyone whose ear we can bend in our direction, once we find ourselves on a healing mission! It is the results that fuel that mission, often long past any function it might serve as commerce or career. I would like to share a couple examples with you... the kind of experiences that one never forgets, and I hope the kind that will give you the hope, the faith, and the courage to enter into the unknown territory that is accelerated self-healing.

Case History: Preventing Blindness

John is a well-known radio personality and film producer with a wealth of knowledge and experience in the nutritional field. To his frustration, despite a healthy diet and nutritional supplementation, he had progressed from the typical dry macular degeneration to the more serious wet macular degeneration, with scarring, retinal bleeding and inflammation in the left eye at the age of 65. Visual acuity in that eye had progressively dropped from 20/30+ to 20/80, a disturbing 50% loss of vision, in a period of just six months.

Very concerned about the rapid deterioration in John's vision, Harvard trained retinal specialist Dr. Bruce Ballon immediately set up an emergency appointment for laser cauterization of the leaking blood vessels, explaining that "time is of the essence" and that John might permanently lose the opportunity to delay progression of the disease by postponing treatment. John, however, having had many positive experiences over the years with nutrition, elected to give natural vision care one last, but concerted effort to save his vision, knowing that laser treatment would certainly cause some additional damage to retinal tissue, even with the hoped for outcome of "delayed progression."

John obtained a copy of this book and followed the recommendations carefully, building a comprehensive natural program of antioxidants, bioflavonoids, minerals and targeted botanicals around the foundation of eating well and taking a good multi-vitamin that he already had in place. For years he had also been taking an aspirin product for his headaches; when he learned it could be contributing to his retinal bleeding, he stopped, and was pleased to find that his headaches actually subsided once he did.

At John's last checkup, Dr. Ballon was extremely pleased with his response, stating that he had never seen such fast recovery in twelve years of practice. The retinal drusen were no longer swollen and decomposing; the bleeding, inflammatory and degenerative processes had been halted completely, and even the retinal scarring was being reversed. Dr. Ballon later wrote, "...Mr. DeCosta has had dramatic improvement in his vision despite having had wet macular degeneration. The improvement in his vision occurred after beginning intensive use of powerful antioxidants, vitamins and herbal treatment... I appreciate all of the work that you did on a subject that obviously needs more research, but is very promising for patients who have very few alternatives." John's vision had been fully restored to 20/40.

Case History: Reversing Blindness

At 80 years of age, Verna of the island of Hawaii had become one of the statistics. After suffering loss of her central vision in both eyes due to

wet macular degeneration, she was classified as legally blind, with vision of only 20/400 in the right eye and 20/200 in the left eye.

Wanting to do everything she could to save her remaining sight, she contacted Dr. Swartwout at the Remission Foundation. Consulting together, a monthly program was developed and modified periodically to keep Verna on track with the most helpful supplements and dietary changes at each stage of her healing. After one year, her ophthalmologist almost couldn't believe his eyes, or hers. The bleeding had completely stopped in both eyes, and her vision had been restored to 20/70 and 20/50. Thanks to her diligence in applying natural vision care, Verna was no longer blind, and looking forward to turning 83.

Preface

This book is my compilation of notes through several decades of healing practice, as a self-healer (I was supposed to be dead 30 years ago), as a Doctor of Optometry, as a Naturopath, as a practitioner of European Biological Medicine, and as a minister of healing.

Healing the body is important, ultimately, because we inhabit this bio-body suit, as mentor William Tiller calls it. Freeing the body of disease, or darkness, as it is called in scripture, frees the soul to experience life, and so to navigate this world as we prepare for our rebirth into the next world of even greater dimensionality and mystery... In the meantime, it is these challenges that stimulate us to develop our unique gifts, the most precious streams of grace that make us uniquely who we are.

My primary approach to healing is to remove any major blocks to the body's natural self-healing process. This allows the whole body, with all its major systems, to function synergistically. I call this accelerated self-healing.

In this state of energetic coherence, where all the acupuncture meridians are flowing as if on the same circuit breaker, I believe the consciousness of the spirit body is also able to experience a subtle but profound depth of opportunity for integration, as well.

I hope this book serves in some way, whether technical or inspirational, along your healing path. Please help pay it forward, and shine your light for others...

Introduction

The macula lutea of the human eye is a remarkable gift, providing us with keen central vision. In order to do that, it is constructed without any blood supply, making it acutely sensitive to the circulation all around it. On top of this, the macula is the most metabolically active tissue in the human body, requiring more oxygen than any other. It becomes understandable then, that this delicate balance of avascularity and high oxygen demand can lead to hypoxia and associated tissue degeneration if there are interferences in circulation, oxygenation, aerobic metabolism, or any of the myriad supportive functions along the way, such as the heart, the lungs and the digestive system.

The wonder of the work outlined in this book is that even in cases where damage has occurred, including scarring of this delicate tissue, which is embryologically brain tissue, we have been able to produce conditions that support healing, with regeneration of visual function and even reduction of already formed scar tissue.

The body is constantly repairing itself. It is constantly restoring its structure and function, as a standing wave, largely made of completely different particles today than it was made of just a few years ago. It is constantly cycling through periods of cleansing and rebuilding according to the cycles of nature, including the seasons, and even the cycles of the moon. When we begin to respect this divine intelligence of the body enough to listen to its functional responses to our hypotheses for supporting and stimulating its healing and repair, we enter a new era of medicine. The medicine of the future...

I call this medicine Biofield Analysis, because the biofield is the preferred terminology of the National Institute of Health for the body's energy field. The work I have been focusing on for the past four and a half decades comes from German electronic engineering applied to the

5,000 year healing traditions of traditional Oriental Medicine. In the 1950s, Dr. Reinhold Voll was teaching other physicians how to measure the impedance of acupuncture points before and after acupuncture treatment as a means of quality control. A serendipitous occurrence led to the observation that an energetically correct homeopathic medicine, even just located within the one centimeter radiant energy field of the body, produced a temporary change in the energetic responses of the acupuncture points. Each hypothesis for a therapeutic action in every patient can be tested for the body's reaction of acceptance or rejection in real time. Conventionally, clinical trials take weeks or months to provide feedback as to their efficacy. When we listen to the body, the feedback is immediate.

My love for this work has extended beyond my chosen seclusion from commerce to pursue the generation of a more spiritually constructive culture of sacred giving, and though I seek to live a simple, holy life including a vow of worldly poverty, I continue to be called to pursue the understanding of the natural self-healing processes that this work has graced me with as a central element of my ministry. This calling leads me to republish this work in order to share these remarkable benefits with you, dear reader, whether you seek to heal your own vision, or that of a loved one... or whether you are called to healing work yourself beyond the role of caregiver, as a practitioner or physician.

I am here to help in what ways I may... May your journey be blessed!

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What is the Macula?

The macula, or macula lutea ("yellow spot"), is the central part of the retina, responsible for our detailed vision. This is the part of the eye we look with, and is necessary for reading, writing, identifying faces and many other detailed visual tasks that most people take for granted. Slower reading with aging is one of the early signs of macular degeneration.

The incidence of macular degeneration increases from under 1% for people under age 50 to over a quarter of the population over age 75. In all, over 15 million Americans have macular degeneration, with 167,000 new cases added each year. It is the leading cause of irreversible blindness in this country. The two basic types are dry (85%) and wet (about 15%). Most cases progress slowly, while less than 10%, mostly of the wet type, progress rapidly. Some cases of wet macular degeneration are treatable by laser surgery, but the treatment itself cannot effectively seal up a leaking blood vessel without at the same time permanently destroying the retinal nerve fibers that pass through that area. This is why laser treatment can actually worsen vision, as reported by the National Eye Institute, and any ability to slow the progression of disease does not appear until at least a year after surgery. One surgeon states, "it is now increasingly evident that laser treatment will not significantly reduce the severe visual loss experienced by most patients with this macular disease.... Preventive measures, such as nutritional supplements and light filtration, should also be investigated in the hope of decelerating progressive, atrophic degeneration."

As always, prevention is the best medicine, when it is instituted in time and in adequate measure. Since less than 1% of those with macular degeneration have progressed to the point of legal blindness, most are in a position to greatly benefit from prevention.

Nutritional Factors

Free radical pathology is a key feature of macular degeneration. The macula is the most metabolically active tissue in the body, and therefore produces the most free radicals. It is simultaneously the most dependent upon adequate circulation, not only to deliver oxygen, but antioxidant and other nutrients as well as to remove metabolic waste products.

There are hundreds of research studies that show nutritional factors play a role in macular health. In treating a series of 60 patients with macular degeneration using the nutrients discussed in this book, over

half sustained improvements in visual acuity. An increased intake of fresh, ripe, organically grown fruits and vegetables is highly recommended along with the more targeted nutritional support that follows.

Fats and Oils

Thirty percent of the fat molecules in the brain and retina are docosahexaenoic acid (DHA), a long-chain essential fatty acid. In the photoreceptor cells specifically, DHA comprises 60% of the fats. DHA is made in the body from essential omega-3 fatty acids found in foods such as dark green leafy vegetables, walnuts, and flax seeds, but during degenerative processes the body cannot make adequate amounts, and dietary supplementation becomes important to help maintain or regenerate normal visual acuity. DHA is available pre-formed in fish oil, such as salmon oil, and in vegetarian DHA capsules derived from algae.

A low-fat diet may help reduce the risk of macular degeneration, with avoidance of red meat and dairy products. Avoidance of margarine and other hydrogenated (trans) oils is especially important in wet macular degeneration; it can take six months to a year to clear up their effects even after they are eliminated from the diet. Soft drusen are hydrophobic deposits of apparently undigestible fats, and increasing essential fatty acids while reducing trans, hydrogenated, rancid and oxidized fats in the diet may help reduce drusen formation, since essential fatty acids loosen the structure of fat-soluble cell membranes, while cholesterol, for example, increases rigidity.

There is much more waiting for you. This starter excerpt is only the case histories, preface, introduction, and the opening pages of the first chapter of *Macular Degeneration... Macular Regeneration*. The full book goes on to walk through the rest of Dr. Glen's research and clinical experience with this condition, chapter by chapter: the complete picture of risk factors, the full nutritional protocol (vitamins, minerals, amino acids and more), botanicals, glandulars and

hormones, light therapy, homeopathy, laboratory and clinical testing, and the biofeedback methods he uses to match each remedy to each person's own physiology.

If what you've just read resonates with where you are right now, whether you're newly diagnosed, managing macular degeneration long-term, or supporting someone who is, the full book is the next step. And whenever you are ready to go further, Dr. Glen's Accelerated Self Healing work opens up through his free membership at illtowell.com. It costs nothing to begin.